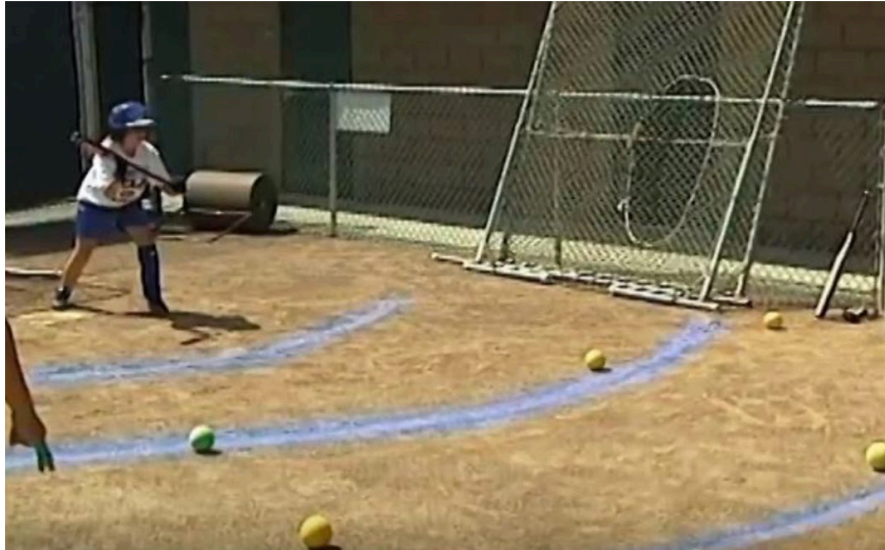


Purpose:

Players learn to deaden the ball and bunt to specific areas.

Setup:

Draw three semicircles in the dirt in front of home plate: 4 feet, 8 feet, and 12 feet from the plate.

**Instructions:**

1. The batter tries to bunt into one of the three zones. A bunt into the first zone is 5 points, the second zone is 3 points, and the third zone is 1 point.
2. Players keep track of their score; the player finishing with the highest score wins.

Coaching Tips:

- Remind players to lower the bat by bending the knees, not the waist.
- Players should have a wide stance to increase balance.
- The barrel of the bat should always start at the top of the zone at a slight angle.

Tips for Younger Athletes:

- Encourage younger players to watch the ball all the way to the bat. This helps improve hand-eye coordination and ensures better contact.
- Remind younger athletes to hold the bat loosely in their fingers, not in their palms, to allow for better control and a softer touch.
- Teach younger players to angle the bat slightly downwards to help deaden the ball, ensuring it stays within the desired zone.

Tips for Older Athletes:

- Older players should focus on the precision of their bunt, aiming for specific spots within each zone to improve accuracy.
- Encourage experienced players to vary their bunts by practicing both drag and push bunts, adding versatility to their offensive skills.
- For older athletes, emphasize the importance of situational awareness. Teach them to read the defense and adjust their bunt placement accordingly.